

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Tamilakam geography and tinai

VENKATAM / TIRUPATI HILLS -> conventional northern marker

WESTERN UPLANDS -> Chera-linked pepper and coast

KAVERI-MARUTAM -> wet agriculture, Uraiyur and Puhar

MADURAI-KORKAI -> Pandya court, pearls and southern coast

TINAI: kurinji | mullai | marutam | neital | palai

RULE: tinai is a poetic-ecological model, not a fixed revenue or cadastral map.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Evidence and chronology architecture

MEGALITHIC / IRON-AGE BACKGROUND

- > Ashokan southern-polity references
- > Tamil-Brahmi names, donors and offices
- > early historic poems, coins, ports and ceramics
- > later anthology and redaction

METHOD: poem + inscription + archaeology + external text

LIMIT: c. 300 BCE-300 CE is a broad evidentiary horizon, not one synchronized reign.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Sangam corpus: akam and puram

ETTUTTOKAI + PATTUPATTU + TOLKAPPIYAM

AKAM

PURAM

interior / love

public / war / gift / fame

landscape convention

chief, bard and heroic ethic

social and emotional codes political-redistributive values

USE: recover vocabulary and institutions.

LIMIT: genre and later compilation prevent literal chronicle reading.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Chera, Chola and Pandya comparison

CHERA -> western routes / pepper / Muchiri / Senguttuvan

CHOLA -> Kaveri basin / Uraiyur / Puhar / Karikala

PANDYA -> Madurai / Korkai / pearls / Nedunjelidan

MUVENDAR = three crowned lineages in literary memory

BOUNDARY: named rulers and places do not yield fixed continuous borders.

TRAP: Sangam Cholas are not the later imperial Cholas.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Chiefship, warfare, gift and fame

AGRARIAN / PASTORAL / COASTAL RESOURCES

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raids + warfare + tribute / booty

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court feast and gifts -> followers + bards + dependants

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praise, honour and heroic memory -> renewed legitimacy

VATTakirutal: defeated ruler's ritual fasting in the heroic code.

LIMIT: celebratory poems mute producer costs and coercion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Production and internal exchange

ECOLOGICAL ZONES

- |-- paddy and wet cultivation
- |-- cattle and pastoral products
- |-- fish, salt, pearls, pepper and forest goods
- `-- weaving, beads, shell, iron and other crafts

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markets + chattu caravans + river/coastal movement

RESULT: diversified local production underpinned courts and overseas exchange.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Port and hinterland network

HINTERLAND PRODUCTION -> MARKET / CARAVAN -> PORT

KAVERI BASIN -----> PUHAR

PANDYA SOUTH / PEARL ZONE -----> KORKAI

WESTERN PEPPER CIRCUITS -----> MUCHIRI / MUZIRIS TRADITION

PORT FUNCTIONS: aggregation + customs + shipping + redistribution

RULE: no port flourished without inland producers, routes and consumers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Mediterranean links, Arikamedu and Pattanam

COINS + AMPHORAE + CERAMICS + PAPYRUS / CLASSICAL TEXTS

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Indian Ocean and Mediterranean-linked exchange

ARIKAMEDU: earlier settlement + local craft + imported material

PATTANAM: major connected port evidence; Muziris identification debated

NOT PROVED: Roman colony, Roman sovereignty or foreign creation of Tamil economy.

VERDICT: multi-nodal contact amplified indigenous production and routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Society, labour, women and varna

COURT ELITES / CHIEFS / BARDS / WARRIORS

MERCHANTS / ARTISANS / CULTIVATORS / PASTORALISTS

FISHERS / SALT WORKERS / OTHER DEPENDANT LABOUR

WOMEN: poetry, spinning, fishing, salt exchange and household work

VARNA vocabulary was known; regional social practice was not a neat four-box census.

RULE: occupational visibility or named women does not prove equality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Religion, culture and megalithic context

MURUGAN / MAYON / KORRAVAI + Brahmanical vocabulary

JAIN / BUDDHIST donors and cave contexts

HEROIC AND MORTUARY MEMORY -> poems, stones and burials

MEGALITHS -> varied forms, grave goods, iron and pottery

LIMIT: burial evidence does not automatically disclose settlement map or exact belief.

CULTURE: plurality emerged through local traditions and wider exchanges.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Chiefdom-to-state debate

CHIEFDOM READING -> personal retinue, raid, gift and bardic prestige

STATE READING -> centres, extraction, titles, offices and durable lineages

EVIDENCE -> ko/kon, Pugalur, Mangulam, ports and agrarian cores

TRADE -> amplifier, not sole creator

IRON -> enabling technology, not sole cause

VERDICT: uneven movement toward early states; regional and reversible.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ and answer spine

PRELIMS: varna awareness | ports | Vattakirutal | ruler-lineage pairs

MAINS OPENING: evidentiary horizon, not one synchronized dynasty block

BODY 1: geography and source method

BODY 2: polity + economy + society + culture

BODY 3: port-hinterland mechanism and one historiographical debate

QUALIFY: genre, chronology, identification and representativeness

VERDICT: connected, uneven chiefdom-to-early-state Tamilakam.